EL NIÑO ACTION BRIEFING · 30 OCTOBER 2026

Jacobabad, Sindh

Heat here kills in the spring after an El Niño winter, and it kills through the power cut: keep electricity on at the heatstroke rooms and the water plant before March.

IMPACT REGION	EXCESS HEAT DEATHS	WINDOW	DOMINANT HAZARD
Sindh province (tracker, province level)	810 forecast for Sindh, 320 of them in March; 5,300 already past (Jun–Sep)	6-month forecast, Oct 2026 – Mar 2027	Extreme heat (worst in May–June), with power and water failure; flood in La Niña years

13/13 recommendations checked. 7 corrected, 1 unverified, 4 contraindicated (the four "Do not do this" cards; one of them, a heat-insurance design, was found in verification). All 8 For you steps were checked too, and 5 were corrected. Exposure figure: Climate Impact Lab El Niño Heat Mortality Tracker data, version of 26 October 2026, pre-peer-review, methods forthcoming. It is published for Sindh province, not for Jacobabad, and it counts heat only. Our population share puts about 17 of Sindh's 810 forecast deaths in Jacobabad district, about 7 of them in March; that is our arithmetic, not a tracker finding, and probably low, because Jacobabad is hotter than the Sindh average. The tracker stops at March. Jacobabad's deadliest heat comes in May and June, so most of the risk these actions address falls after the window the number covers. The funding target fell from the panel's PKR 25.3 million (US$91,400) to PKR 12.0 million (US$43,400) after verification (−53%), because the water plant's operator could not be confirmed and Start Network may already pay for the heatstroke supplies.

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY — AT A GLANCE



28.28°N 68.44°E, Pakistan · Natural Earth

- **The risk.** Jacobabad reaches 50°C or more in most recent years (51–52°C in May 2024); people who cannot afford to leave die when the power and the water fail together.
- **For you.** As a resident, learn heatstroke first aid now: cool the person at once with any water you have, immerse them if you can, and wet the skin before using a fan. It costs nothing.*
- **The money.** Floor PKR 6.0 million (US$21,700), target PKR 12.0 million (US$43,400), ceiling PKR 39.3 million (US$141,900); solar backup at the three heatstroke centres buys the most lives.
- **Do not.** Do not hold back cold water from someone with heatstroke for fear of "shock": rapid cooling is the treatment.*

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* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

FOR YOU, AS A RESIDENT 8 STEPS

In Jacobabad the danger is a May or June afternoon above 48°C with the power off and the water seller late. The families most at risk are the ones who stay in the city for the summer. The ranked actions below are written for the district and its partners. These are the ones you can take yourself.

Learn heatstroke first aid now: cool at once with any water, immerse if you can, and wet the skin before using a fan *

CONFIRMED ROLE-SPECIFIC (DO-NOT 3 AND 2)

BY WHEN	COST TO YOU	PROTECTS
Before 1 March 2027	None	Anyone in the household who collapses in the heat

Critical-care guidance now says to cool both classic and exertional heatstroke with cold water or ice, and for an older person a wet cloth plus fanning is acceptable when a tub is not practical (SCCM 2025; Wilderness Medical Society). In Jacobabad's dry 45–50°C heat a fan alone blows hot air over the body, so wet the skin first (Morris et al., Lancet Planetary Health 2021). Then get the person to a heat stabilisation centre.*

Know where your nearest heat stabilisation centre is: DHQ (Civil) Hospital Jacobabad, THQ Garhi Khairo, or RHC Mirpur Burriro

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED FROM ACTION 2

BY WHEN	COST TO YOU	PROTECTS
Before April 2027	None	Older people, outdoor workers, pregnant women

The Community Development Foundation (CDF) and the district health office have run these centres since 2022, and the District Health Officer credits them with more than 42,500 patients over three years, including chronic-illness patients as well as heatstroke (Prepare Center, April 2026). PDMA Sindh listed these three sites in its 2025 heatwave reports. Ask CDF which one serves your area before the season starts.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

Keep a rolling stock of drinking water in clean, sealed, shaded containers from March, and budget about PKR 80 a day for it

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | FROM ACTION 6

BY WHEN	COST TO YOU	PROTECTS
From 1 March 2027	About PKR 80 (US$0.29) a day for two containers	Drinking water through a power cut or a late water seller

Most households here buy drinking water because the groundwater is saline; two containers a day cost about PKR 80 in 2026, roughly double the 2022 price (Dawn, 22 June 2026; Al Jazeera, May 2022). Rotate the stock rather than buying it all at once, because stored water degrades.

Buy ten ORS sachets for the household*

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | ROLE-SPECIFIC

BY WHEN	COST TO YOU	PROTECTS
28 February 2027	About PKR 200–300 (US$0.70–1.10)	Children with diarrhoea, anyone weak from heat

ORS sachets cost about PKR 20–30 each in 2026 (Peditral Rs 30, Osmolar Rs 21 on retail listings); drug prices were deregulated in November 2025, so check the printed price. ORS treats dehydration; it does not treat heatstroke, which needs cooling first.*

If your roof is tin, paint it with white reflective roof coat before the heat

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | ROLE-SPECIFIC

BY WHEN	COST TO YOU	PROTECTS
15 March 2027	About PKR 4,000 (US$14) per 4 litres	Everyone sleeping or cooking under that roof

In an Ahmedabad slum study, white paint on tin roofs lowered indoor temperature by about 1.1°C (Vellingiri et al., 16 homes); a 600-home trial in Burkina Faso has reported 1.2–1.7°C in preliminary results, with no gain at night. The benefit is largest on tin and small on concrete. Diamond Roof Coat lists at Rs 3,978 for 4 L (Diamond Paints).

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

Update your household record in BISP's register (NSER) at the BISP tehsil registration centre

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | FROM ACTION 9

BY WHEN	COST TO YOU	PROTECTS
Before the January 2027 instalment	None	Household income through the lean season

Updates are free with your CNIC and children's B-Forms, but the record must match NADRA first, so register any change in the family at NADRA before going to the BISP desk (BISP). Kafaalat pays Rs 14,500 a quarter now and is due to rise to Rs 18,000 from January 2027.

If someone in the house is pregnant, breastfeeding, or under two, ask about Benazir Nashonuma

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | ROLE-SPECIFIC

BY WHEN	COST TO YOU	PROTECTS
Before March 2027	None	Mothers and small children through the lean season

Nashonuma provides free specialised food for women in BISP-registered households who are pregnant, breastfeeding, or have a child under two; you need a CNIC, a B-Form, and immunisation records. We could not confirm a Nashonuma centre in Jacobabad, so check through the BISP 8171 portal or the district BISP office first.

Put any older relative who lives alone on CDF's vulnerable-household list, and agree who checks on them during a night power cut

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | FROM ACTION 4

BY WHEN	COST TO YOU	PROTECTS
Before March 2027	None	Older people living alone; households with no power at night

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

Roughly half the city leaves for the summer, and the people who stay are those who cannot afford to go (Arab News). Only 34% of households surveyed by CDF had working cooling in 2023 (CDF baseline). A named neighbour who knocks during an outage is the cheapest protection there is.

What to ask of the people in charge

- Ask SEPCO, through the Deputy Commissioner and the Sindh Energy Department, to clear illegal hooks from the water plant's feeder and keep the hospital feeders on during PMD heat alerts (action 1).
- Ask the District Health Officer whether each heat stabilisation centre will have an immersion tub, ice, and a core thermometer before March (action 2).
- Ask the Sindh Food Department why Upper Sindh mills have no quota in the subsidised wheat release (action 8).

WHAT THIS PLACE SHOULD DO — RANKED

Ranked by expected lives saved per unit of effort before the peak. Backing lenses are shown per action; an action several lenses reached independently is the stronger bet.

1. Keep the power on where it saves lives: clear the hooks from the water plant's feeder, protect the hospital feeders during heat alerts, and fit solar-plus-battery backup at the three heat stabilisation centres by 1 March 2027

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | EMERGENCY MANAGER · SKEPTIC · PUBLIC HEALTH · ECONOMIST · PHILANTHROPIST | ADAPTATION INVENTORY: NOT QUERYABLE

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
SEPCO, asked through the DC and the Sindh Energy Department; CDF for the solar	1 March 2027	PKR 4.5 million (US$16,300) for solar at three sites, estimate; feeder protection is administrative	Heatstroke rooms and the city's only treated water failing at the hottest hour

The filtration plant needs six hours of uninterrupted power a day on its own feeder, and Dawn reported "influential" users tapping that feeder (Dawn, 2021). Load-shedding ran 14–16 hours a day in June 2026 (Dawn, 2026), and SEPCO cut 407 of its 707 feeders for more than 10 hours a day in early 2026 (The News). In 2023 the DHQ heatstroke centre had no electricity during a reporter's visit (The News on

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

Sunday). No source shows solar at any of the centres. A 5–6 kW hybrid system with 10 kWh of lithium storage is quoted at about PKR 0.9–1.5 million in 2026, before any air-conditioning load.

Corrected in verification: the Deputy Commissioner has no authority over SEPCO's load plan, and NEPRA regulates rather than orders feeder exemptions; this is a request to SEPCO, backed by the DC and the provincial Energy Department. No effect size exists for this action; it rests on the documented failures here.

2. Equip the existing heat stabilisation centres and Rescue ambulances for rapid cooling: immersion tubs, ice, and core thermometers, before 15 February 2027

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | EMERGENCY MANAGER · HISTORIAN · SKEPTIC · PUBLIC HEALTH | ADAPTATION INVENTORY: NOT QUERYABLE

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
District Health Officer, with CDF	15 February 2027	PKR 4 million (US$14,500), estimate; check Start Network's 2027 cover first	Deaths from heatstroke treated too slowly

The centres exist: CDF and the district built them at the DHQ, the sub-district hospitals, and rural health centres from 2022, and the District Health Officer credits them with more than 42,500 patients in three years (Prepare Center). What decides survival is how fast the core temperature falls, and the 2025 critical-care guidance is to cool with cold water or ice for both classic and exertional heatstroke (SCCM 2025).*

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

Corrected in verification: this is an upgrade of existing centres, not a new build; the 42,500 includes chronic-illness patients; the often-quoted "50–60 cases a day" is one doctor's estimate, and the same report gives 4–5 heatstroke admissions a day. Payer: the Sindh Health Department through the DHO, or Start Network if its 2027 allocation includes supplies.

3. Make sure the only pre-arranged money moves in March, not May: Start Network confirms its 2027 Jacobabad activation window and checks its forecast trigger against the PMD Jacobabad station by 15 February 2027

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | ECONOMIST · HISTORIAN · EMERGENCY MANAGER | ADAPTATION INVENTORY: NOT QUERYABLE

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
Start Network (READY Pakistan), with CDF	15 February 2027	No new money; staff time	Cooling centres and the ice bank opening after the first deaths

Start Network's Pakistan heatwave risk-financing system names Jacobabad as one of six sites and triggers on a NOAA GFS heat-index forecast, but publishes its season only as "the hottest months" (Start Network). CDF's 2026 action began on 1 May (CDF), yet the tracker puts 320 of Sindh's 810 forecast deaths in March. The Pakistan Red Crescent has only a flood Early Action Protocol (IFRC, EAP2025PK02); a heat DREF request is the backstop if Start's window does not cover March.

Corrected in verification: the 13,000 people, GBP 60,000, and GBP 180,000 figures the panel gave are unsourced and were removed. The only published payout from this system is GBP 36,000 for Karachi in 2020, and that was a false positive. Checking against PMD is a reasonable ask, not current practice.

4. List the people who stay for the summer, door to door, and reach the women inside homes through women volunteers and Lady Health Workers, November to February

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | FRONTLINE · PUBLIC HEALTH · PHILANTHROPIST · SKEPTIC | ADAPTATION INVENTORY: NOT QUERYABLE

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
CDF, with volunteers and Lady Health Workers	28 February 2027	PKR 6.0 million (US$21,700) to extend from 12 to 36 communities, estimate	Deaths among people official warnings never reach

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

Roughly half of the city's 200,000 people leave for the summer; daily-wage earners, brick-kiln families, and the off-grid settlements stay (Arab News). Only 34% of households had working cooling in CDF's 2023 baseline (CDF). Women cooking over open fires in closed rooms are reached by women visitors, not by men's meetings. Use the mosque loudspeaker, the ice and water sellers who visit every household daily, and Sindhi first (90% of the city), then Brahui and Balochi.

Corrected in verification: CDF already maps vulnerable households in 12 communities under Start Network, so this extends that work rather than starting it; the language shares are city figures (Sindhi 90.2%, Brahui 1.0%), not the district's.

5. Start counting heat deaths: add the heatstroke code (ICD-10 T67) to the district health information system and run a daily all-cause death count from graveyards and union councils from 1 March 2027

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | PUBLIC HEALTH · EMERGENCY MANAGER · HISTORIAN · SKEPTIC | ADAPTATION INVENTORY: NOT QUERYABLE

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
Sindh Health Department, through the DHO	1 March 2027	PKR 1.5 million (US$5,400), estimate	A trigger and a budget that cannot exist while the deaths are invisible

In 2021 the Director General of Health Services said there had been no reported heatstroke deaths in Jacobabad in three years; Dawn noted that no such data is collected (Dawn). Ahmedabad could show its heat plan avoided about 1,190 deaths a year (95% CI 162–2,218) only because it counted all deaths daily (Hess et al. 2018). Bangladesh's DHIS2 already codes T67 (DHIS2 community).

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

Corrected in verification: the "no heatstroke column" claim comes from an anonymous doctor; no national rule requires heat surveillance; the Ahmedabad study is an ecological before-and-after pilot, not a trial.

6. Find out who runs the city water plant now, and fund its operation through June 2027 only against metered daily supply

UNVERIFIED | HISTORIAN · SKEPTIC · PHILANTHROPIST | ADAPTATION INVENTORY: NOT QUERYABLE

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
Municipal Committee Jacobabad	Confirm by 15 December 2026; fund March–June 2027	PKR 11.3 million (US$40,800) for four months of staff, estimate, only once the operator is confirmed	Families falling back on unsafe tanker and groundwater in May and June

The USAID-built plant (5.7 million litres a day, about 350,000 people in its catchment) was handed to the Municipal Committee in 2021. In February 2025 the US aid freeze blocked PKR 415 million (US$1.5 million) and its operator sent 47 staff home (Dawn). Even before that, power limited it: it met only 3–4 of about 8 million gallons a day of demand, and diesel at about PKR 830,000 (US$3,000) a day was unaffordable (VICE).

Unverified: no report after February 2025 says whether the plant is running, who operates it, or whether its staff are still available. The 350,000 is larger than the city's 2023 census population of 219,315, so it is a catchment figure. Do not place money until the status is confirmed.

7. Agree a heat working window, shade, and water breaks with the brick-kiln owners for about 5,000 workers before April 2027

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | FRONTLINE · PUBLIC HEALTH · ECONOMIST | ADAPTATION INVENTORY: NOT QUERYABLE

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
Deputy Commissioner, with the Sindh Labour Department	1 April 2027	Administrative; lost piece-rate wages are unfunded	Heat illness among workers paid by the brick, who cannot afford to rest

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

About 5,000 kiln workers make a daily quota of 1,000 bricks for under PKR 1,400 (US$5); one 70-year-old worker said that if he rested his family would go hungry (Amnesty, 2021). Work-rest-water programmes improved kidney outcomes among Nicaraguan sugarcane cutters once management committed to them (OEM 2025).

Corrected in verification: there is no Sindh heat labour rule and no past Jacobabad order on kiln hours, so this is a new ask, not a renewal. The evidence comes from a different population and measures kidney outcomes, not deaths. Because workers are paid by the brick, shorter hours cost them money; that gap is unfunded.

8. Give Upper Sindh mills, including Jacobabad's, a quota in the subsidised wheat release before the February–March price peak

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | FOOD SUPPLY CHAIN | ADAPTATION INVENTORY: NOT QUERYABLE

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
Sindh Food Department	From November 2026, ahead of February–March 2027	No new money; an allocation from stock already released at Rs 12,500 per 100 kg	The lean-season flour peak reaching Upper Sindh first

Sindh began releasing government wheat to mills on 15 October 2026 at Rs 12,500 per 100 kg, from 836,414 t expected in hand; the published quotas go to Karachi (565,948 t), Hyderabad (30,000 t), and Mirpurkhas with Shaheed Benazirabad (60,000 t), and none to Sukkur, Larkana, or Jacobabad (Express Tribune). Flour was Rs 2,851 per 20 kg in the week to 8 October, up 32.6% on a year. FEWS NET expects such measures to hold prices for only one to three months, with the peak likely in February–March (FEWS NET).

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

Corrected in verification: the Rs 2,851 is a 17-city national average, not a Sindh price; watch the weekly PBS figures for Sukkur and Larkana, the nearest cities covered. This winter's flour shock comes from a procurement shortfall, not from El Niño; El Niño's channel is the April 2027 harvest, after a monsoon 50.8% below normal and a 22% canal-water shortage.

9. Pay the January 2027 Kafaalat instalment at the committed Rs 18,000, on time, before the lean season and the heat

CONFIRMED | FOOD SUPPLY CHAIN · ECONOMIST | ADAPTATION INVENTORY: NOT QUERYABLE

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
BISP, with the Ministry of Finance	January 2027	Within BISP's FY27 allocation, which is Rs 20.8 billion short of the commitment	Meal cuts and distress sales of livestock

Kafaalat pays Rs 14,500 a quarter and is committed to rise to Rs 18,000 from January 2027; the FY27 allocation of Rs 838 billion is Rs 20.8 billion short of the Rs 858.8 billion needed (Business Recorder). FEWS NET finds that incomes, not food availability, are the binding constraint, which favours cash, paired with a mill quota (action 8) so that cash does not simply raise prices.

Confirmed for the amounts and the funding gap. A date earlier than the scheduled instalment is not sourced, so the ask is on time and in full.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

WHO DOES WHAT

RACI CHART

R = Responsible (does the work) · **A** = Accountable (one per action; signs off and answers for it) · **C** = Consulted (asked before) · **I** = Informed (told after). Built from the owners named in the verified actions. No one here has been contacted or has agreed to a role; every row is a proposal.

Action	SEPCO	DC Jacobabad	CDF	DHO Jacobabad	Sindh Health Dept	Start Network	Municipal Committee	Sindh Labour Dept	Sindh Food Dept	BISP
1. Power to heatstroke centres and water plant	**A/R**	**C**	**R**	**C**	**I**					
2. Heatstroke cooling at existing centres			**R**	**A/R**	**I**	**C**				
3. Trigger money that covers March		**C**	**R**	**I**		**A**				
4. Find and reach the people who stay		**I**	**A/R**	**R**						
5. Count heat deaths			**I**	**R**	**A**		**R**			
6. Water plant: confirm operator, then fund	**C**	**C**					**A/R**			
7. Heat working hours at the brick kilns		**A**	**C**					**R**		
8. Wheat quota for Upper Sindh mills		**C**							**A/R**	
9. Kafaalat at Rs 18,000, paid on time		**I**								**A/R**

What the chart shows: SEPCO, the DHO, and CDF carry the rows that decide survival in May. Three rows (power, trigger timing, and the wheat quota) need a decision, not money. CDF appears in five rows, which makes it the single point of failure.

WHERE MONEY DOES THE MOST

FUNDING

The Philanthropist lens, reconciled against the ranked actions and verified. Placements are ranked by marginal lives saved per dollar. The envelope is bounded by what this place can spend before the peak, not by what it needs.

FLOOR

PKR 6.0 million (US$21,700)

TARGET

PKR 12.0 million (US$43,400)

CEILING

PKR 39.3 million (US$141,900)

LARGEST UNCERTAINTY

Whether the water plant is running, and what Start Network funds in 2027

Floor = solar backup at three centres, 3 × PKR 1.5 million = 4.5 million, plus heat-death counting 1.5 million = PKR 6.0 million. Target = floor + outreach from 12 to 36 communities, 24 × PKR 250,000 = 6.0 million, so PKR 12.0 million. Ceiling = target + water-plant staff, 47 × PKR 60,000 × 4 months = 11.28 million, + cool roofs for 2,000 homes × PKR 8,000 = 16.0 million, so PKR 39.28 million. Every unit cost is an estimate; none is a quote. The panel's target was PKR 25.3 million; it fell by 53% in verification, because the water plant's operator could not be confirmed and immersion supplies likely overlap Start Network's funding. CDF publishes no budgets, so check its 2027 lines before giving.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

RECIPIENT	USE	AMOUNT	MECHANISM	BASIS	VERDICT
CDF (Community Development Foundation)	Solar-plus-battery backup at DHQ Jacobabad, THQ Garhi Khairo, and RHC Mirpur Burriro (action 1)	PKR 4.5 million (US$16,300)	Restricted grant	No cost-per-death study; vendor quotes of PKR 0.9–1.5 million per 5–6 kW hybrid system, 2026	PARTIALLY CONFIRMED
District Health Office Jacobabad	T67 coding and daily all-cause death count (action 5)	PKR 1.5 million (US$5,400)	Direct grant	Estimate; the precondition for any trigger or evaluation (Hess et al. 2018)	PARTIALLY CONFIRMED
CDF	Extend outreach and early warning from 12 to 36 communities (action 4)	PKR 6.0 million (US$21,700)	Direct grant	Estimate, 24 × PKR 250,000; 12-community programme confirmed (CDF 2026 brief)	PARTIALLY CONFIRMED
Municipal Committee Jacobabad (water scheme)	Bridging staff pay March–June 2027 against metered supply (action 6)	PKR 11.3 million (US$40,800)	Top-up, paid against verified supply	Estimate, 47 × PKR 60,000 × 4; recipient's 2026 status unconfirmed	UNVERIFIED
No implementer found in Jacobabad	White reflective roof coat for 2,000 tin-roofed homes with older members (For you step 5)	PKR 16.0 million (US$57,800)	Grant, if an implementer is found	About 1.1°C indoor (Ahmedabad, 16 homes); unit cost from Mahila Housing Trust at about INR 2,500 a roof	UNVERIFIED

The cheapest lives here are bought by keeping existing assets running, not by new projects: power to the heatstroke rooms comes first. Money committed after January will not be installed before the March heat.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

Do not do this

CONTRAINDICATED · ADVICE THAT WOULD COST LIVES HERE

Advice that circulates for this hazard and would cost lives here.

Do not hold back cold water or ice from someone with heatstroke for fear of "shock" *

CONTRAINDICATED

The folk caution is wrong and costs minutes that decide survival. Critical-care guidance (SCCM 2025) prioritises cold-water or ice immersion for classic and exertional heatstroke, and Pakistan's National Institute of Health endorses cool water and ice packs.

Instead: Cool at once with whatever water is available; immerse if you can; for a frail older person, wet the skin and fan. Then take them to a heat stabilisation centre.

Do not hand out fans as the heat measure in Jacobabad's dry 45–50°C heat *

CONTRAINDICATED

Above about 39°C (38°C for people over 65, 37°C for people on anticholinergic medicines), a fan blowing dry air adds heat to the body. Morris et al. (Lancet Planetary Health 2021) name the dry heat of northern India and Pakistan as unsuitable for fans alone.

Instead: Pair any fan with skin wetting, and put money into power backup and cool rooms instead.

Do not open cooling centres or water plants that run only on the grid

CONTRAINDICATED

Both have failed here: the water plant stops when its feeder is overloaded or cut, and the DHQ heatstroke centre had no electricity during a 2023 visit. Load-shedding of 14–16 hours a day means a grid-only centre is dark when it is needed.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

Instead: Require solar or diesel backup and a funded operator contract that runs past the donor cycle before opening anything new.

Do not buy heat insurance for kiln workers that pays when Jacobabad passes 47°C on two days

CONTRAINDICATED

The panel proposed this; verification contraindicated it. Jacobabad reached 50°C or more in 2021, 2022, 2024, and 2025, so a 47°C trigger fires nearly every year and the premium would cost almost as much as the payout. No heat-income product exists in Pakistan, and one could not be filed with the regulator and sold before March.

Instead: Put the money into cash through BISP and the kiln working window (action 7). If an index product is ever built, set its trigger near 50°C and price it on the station's record.

WHAT HAS HAPPENED HERE BEFORE — THE RECORD

YEAR	EVENT	TOLL	WHAT CHANGED AFTER
1919	Reported record of 52.8°C on 12 June	Unknown	Secondary sources only; no PMD primary record found
2010	Indus flood; the Tori Bund breach (about 7 August) sent water toward the city, and about 95% of residents fled	More than 170 dead, 930,000 affected, and 156,000 homes damaged in the district (UNHCR)	Jacobabad, until then a refuge city, became a flooded one
2015	June heatwave in an El Niño year	1,206–1,234 dead in Karachi; 1,276–1,332 in Sindh (health department counts)	Karachi wrote a heat plan; no evaluation found, and mortuaries overflowed again in 2024
2021	The Director General of Health Services reports no heatstroke deaths in Jacobabad in three years	Not counted	Nothing; no data is collected

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

YEAR	EVENT	TOLL	WHAT CHANGED AFTER
2022	51°C on 14 May (widely reported; no PMD bulletin found), then the monsoon floods	No final death count found; 89,993 houses damaged, 16,043 of them fully (PDMA Sindh)	CDF and the district opened heat stabilisation centres
2024	51–52°C in late May, the spring after the 2023–24 El Niño	No district count	Start Network's pre-arranged heat money covers Jacobabad
2026	Sindh's July–September monsoon 50.8% below normal; PMD names El Niño as a major factor	Not applicable	22% canal-water shortage approved for the 2026–27 wheat season

The recurrence nobody has noticed: Jacobabad's deadliest heat comes in the May after an El Niño winter (2010, 2024), and its floods come in the La Niña years around it (2010, 2022). This El Niño points to May 2027 for heat, beyond the tracker's March horizon, and possibly to a flood in 2027–28. Deaths are not counted, so none of these events has a reliable local toll.

WHERE THE EXPERTS DISAGREE

UNRESOLVED

- **Write a district heat action plan** (public health scientist, historian) versus **fund what already exists and write nothing new** (skeptic, philanthropist). Ahmedabad's plan is the best evidence that plans save lives, but a review of 37 Indian plans found 70% had no financing, and Karachi's plan did not stop the 2024 mortuary overflow. The evidence that would settle it here is a daily death count, which is why action 5 comes first.
- **Rely on Start Network's pre-arranged money** (economist) versus **doubt the trigger** (verification): it is the only money here that moves before the harm, but it fires on a US forecast model, not the city's own thermometer, and its one published payout was a false positive.
- **Cash through BISP** versus **wheat released to mills**: FEWS NET finds incomes are the constraint, which favours cash, but Sindh is short of wheat, so cash alone could raise prices. The two work as a pair (actions 8 and 9).

WHAT NOBODY COVERED

BLIND SPOT

The tracker stops in March, but Jacobabad's killing heat comes in May and June 2027; no lens quantified that season, and no published figure covers it. No lens examined the risk of a flood in the La Niña that often follows, though the 2010 and 2022 floods each displaced most of the

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

city. And nobody could confirm whether the water plant runs today, which leaves the city's only treated water out of the plan.

HOW TO READ THIS — METHOD

The panel is author-built. Eight simulated expert lenses were used to generate these recommendations. Where they agree, that is a strong hypothesis, not a consensus of the field. Every recommendation was then independently checked for evidence, transferability to this location, and feasibility before the peak; the verdict tags carry the result.

Mortality figures are published at province level in the Climate Impact Lab tracker. They are not neighbourhood figures. The El Niño projection covers *heat only*; drought, flood, fire, smoke, and crop failure are additional to it and are carried here by the historical record rather than by a published number.

HOW THIS BRIEFING WAS PRODUCED — METHODOLOGY

- **Scope.** The request named Lal Bazar, Srinagar, as Pakistan. Srinagar is in Indian-administered Jammu and Kashmir, so on 30 October 2026 Angus chose Jacobabad city, Sindh, to cover Pakistan instead. The tracker resolves it to Sindh province (GADM PAK.8_1). Mortality figures exist only at that scale; city detail is used for hazard exposure and action design, not for death counts.
- **Exposure.** Climate Impact Lab El Niño Heat Mortality Tracker data, file `v261026_adm1_output_BASE_rounded_cust.csv` (version of 26 October 2026, pre-peer-review): Sindh, 5,300 additional heat deaths June–September 2026 and 810 forecast October 2026 – March 2027 (October 36, November 180, December 56, January 120, February 100, March 320), 6,100 in total; Pakistan, 15,000; the world, 857,400. This update supersedes the September report *451,000 at Risk*. Method: ECMWF SEAS5 seasonal forecasts applied to temperature–mortality relationships against a 1996–2025 baseline. The figures count heat only. The Jacobabad share (about 17 of 810, and about 129 of 6,100) is our arithmetic, 1,174,097 district residents ÷ 55.7 million in Sindh (2023 census), and not a tracker finding.
- **Expert panel.** Eight simulated expert lenses (emergency manager, public health scientist, frontline responder, skeptic, economist, historian, philanthropist, and food supply chain analyst) each researched this place independently and in parallel, from web sources, to a fixed brief.
- **Reconciliation.** Duplicate actions were merged and backing lenses recorded. Convergence was tested for shared bias (whether the evidence behind an agreed action came from a setting like this one) before it counted in an action's favour. Contradictions were kept, not resolved by dropping a side. Actions were ranked by expected lives saved per unit of effort before the peak, each was given a named payer and trigger or marked unfunded, and the funding placements were reconciled against the ranked list.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

- **Verification.** Five verifier agents checked every recommendation on three tests: evidence (the primary source and its effect size), transferability (whether that evidence came from somewhere like here), and feasibility (whether it can be done here before the peak). Financial actions were also checked for availability in Pakistan, a named payer, a trigger threshold, and whether they already exist; food actions for published triggers and timing. The funding envelope was checked for real recipients, published unit costs, and duplication, then re-summed.
- **Who does what.** The RACI chart is built from the owners named in the verified actions, with one accountable party per action. It is a proposal: no organisation named in it has been contacted or has agreed to a role.
- **Verdicts.** *Confirmed*: evidence, transferability, and feasibility all hold. *Partially confirmed*: holds after the corrections shown. *Unverified*: could not be checked to a primary source. *Contraindicated*: would do harm or waste the window here.
- **Adaptation Inventory.** Could not be consulted. The inventory page is client-side and returned no entries to the verifiers, and the download was not retrieved in this run. Actions tagged "not queryable" are unchecked against it, not shown to lack a precedent.
- **Money.** Costs are shown in Pakistani rupees with US dollars in parentheses, at PKR 276.80 = US$1 (interbank close, 27 October 2026, as reported by pkrevenue.com; the State Bank of Pakistan figure itself could not be retrieved).
- **Reader.** No role was given, so the For you section is written for a resident. The steps were taken from the verified actions and from what the panel found about residents here; any step not drawn from a ranked action was verified on the same three tests. The rest of the report is written for the district and its partners.
- **Health wording.** Passages where a wording error could hurt someone (heatstroke first aid, cooling and fans, oral rehydration salts, and when to take someone for care) are marked "* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing." They were checked against published sources, not by a health professional. They are suggestions, not medical advice, and anyone passing them on should confirm them with a doctor, pharmacist, nurse, or community health worker first. The marker was added on 2 November 2026.
- **Rules.** No cost is derived by dividing a published total, and no local figure is invented; where data is thin, the report says so and shows the containing geography's number with its arithmetic. Costs marked "estimate" are the panel's planning figures, not quotes. Every source is listed below with its verification status.
- **Limits.** The panel and verifiers are AI research agents working from web-available sources, not human experts, and no one in this place was interviewed. Two sources returned errors (the APP procurement report and the IPC report on ReliefWeb), so those figures rest on secondary reporting. No source after February 2025 gives the water plant's status. No district heat-death count exists for any year.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

References · status after verification
Climate Impact Lab, El Niño Heat Mortality Tracker data v261026 (downloaded 30 Oct 2026) · confirmed
Power and water: Dawn 2021; Dawn 2026; The News, SEPCO feeders; The News on Sunday 2023; Dawn, water scheme 2025; VICE · partially confirmed; plant status unverified
Heatstroke care: Prepare Center, CDF centres; SCCM 2025; Wilderness Medical Society; Morris et al. 2021 · confirmed
Surveillance and plans: Hess et al. 2018; DHIS2 T67; CPR review of 37 plans · confirmed
Finance: Start Network DRF Pakistan; CDF 2026 launch; CDF 2026 brief; IFRC EAP2025PK02; Business Recorder, BISP; Dawn, Jacobabad temperatures · partially confirmed; panel figures removed
Food: Express Tribune, wheat release; SPI; Dawn, procurement; FEWS NET; IRSA Rabi shortage; PMD monsoon 2026 · partially confirmed
Community: Arab News; CDF baseline 2023; Amnesty 2021; Jacobabad, census 2023 languages · partially confirmed
Record: Express Tribune 2010; Dawn 2015; Dawn 2024; PDMA Sindh 2022 houses damaged · confirmed or corrected as shown
For you: Diamond Roof Coat; Vellingiri et al.; BISP NSER; Al Jazeera 2022 · corrected
Exposure data · Climate Impact Lab, El Niño Heat Mortality Tracker (data v261026) · 451,000 at Risk (superseded) · Impact Map · Adaptation Inventory
Generated 30 October 2026 for Jacobabad, Sindh. El Niño Ready is volunteer-run and is not affiliated with Climate Week NYC, The Climate Group, or Columbia University.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.